

# Similarities of Japanese and Kazakh Languages

## Words

Words with close pronunciation and same meaning:

| Japanese | pronunciation             | Kazakh   | meaning            |
|----------|---------------------------|----------|--------------------|
| Nouns    |                           |          |                    |
| 天理       | tenri                     | Tangri   | rule of heaven     |
| 日        | hi                        | kun      | day, sun           |
| 水        | sui (onyomi) <sup>1</sup> | su       | water              |
| 家        | ie                        | uy       | house, home        |
| 玩具       | omocha                    | oyinshiq | toy                |
| 腹        | hara                      | qarin    | stomach            |
| 大人       | otona                     | ata-ana  | grown-up (parents) |
| おばあ      | oba                       | apa      | Granmother         |
| 種        | tane                      | dan      | seed               |
| 棘        | toge                      | tiken    | splinter           |
| Verbs    |                           |          |                    |
| 有る       | aru                       | bar      | to be              |
| 入る       | iru                       | kiru     | to enter           |
| 焼く       | yaku                      | jagu     | to dab, spread     |
| 謳う       | utau                      | aytu     | to say             |
| 供える      | sonaeru                   | usinu    | to offer           |
| 吸う       | suu                       | soru     | to suck            |

|     |        |              |                   |
|-----|--------|--------------|-------------------|
| 押す  | osu    | basu         | to press          |
| 撃つ  | utsu   | atu          | to shoot          |
| 急ぐ  | isogu  | asigu        | to hurry, to rush |
| 織る  | oru    | oru          | to weave          |
| 争う  | arasou | jarisu       | to compete        |
| 摺る  | zuru   | suyreu       | to drag           |
| 来る  | kuru   | kelu         | to come           |
| 耐える | taeru  | tayanu       | to stand/endure   |
| 要る  | iru    | kerek (bolu) | be necessary      |

### Adjectives and Adverbs

|      |               |        |                     |
|------|---------------|--------|---------------------|
| 信, 真 | shin (onyomi) | shin   | true, truth         |
| 黒い   | kuroi         | qara   | black               |
| 白    | haku          | aq     | white               |
| 硬い   | katai         | qatti  | solid, rigid        |
| 内    | uchi          | ishi   | inside              |
| 外    | soto          | sirti  | outside             |
| 後    | ato           | arti   | behind, after       |
| 暑い   | atsui         | istiq  | hot                 |
| 近い   | chikai        | jaqin  | near                |
| 道理   | doori         | duris  | right, correct      |
| 濃い   | koi           | qoyu   | deep (color), dense |
| ゆっくり | yukkuri       | aqirin | slow                |

|         |           |                   |                    |
|---------|-----------|-------------------|--------------------|
| いい      | ii        | igi               | good               |
| だけ      | dake      | tek               | just, only         |
| Various |           |                   |                    |
| 何       | nani      | neni <sup>2</sup> | what               |
| ません     | masen     | yemes             | not so             |
| より      | yor       | gori              | than               |
| あの、その   | ano, sono | anau, sonau       | that, those        |
| やばい     | yabai     | oybay             | exclamation phrase |
| ちゃん     | chan      | jan               | diminutive suffix  |

### Notes:

1. **onyomi**" refers to adapted Chinese reading of the character.
2. Kazakh question word "neni" refers to an object, e.g. *bringing what?* / *Neni akelu?* For subject "ne" is used.

## Particles, Endings

The Japanese particles で, へ, の, を vs similar Kazakh endings:

| JP       | KZ                 | Function                                 | Example                                                           |
|----------|--------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| で<br>-de | -da/-de            | Indicative: where?<br>(location)         | さやは家で遊んでいます。<br>Saya uyde oynap otir.<br>Saya is playing at home. |
| へ<br>he  | -ka/-ke<br>-ga/-ge | Indicative: towards, to<br>(destination) | さやは学校へ歩く。<br>Saya mektepke baradi.<br>Sya goes to school.         |

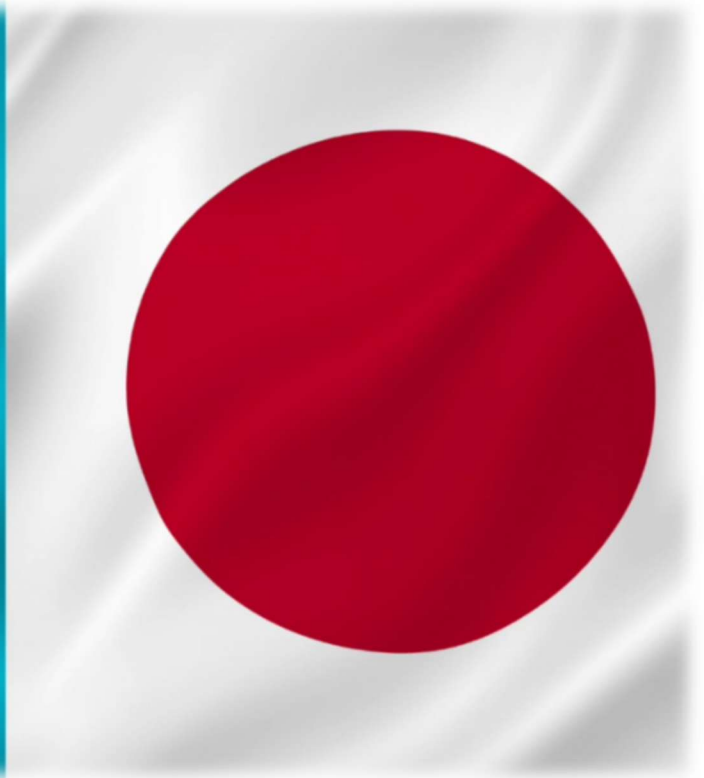
|                |                       |                                                                    |                                                           |
|----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| の<br>no        | (n) <sup>1</sup> -ing | Possessive: belongs to                                             | さやの家がある。<br>Sayaning uyi bar.<br>Saya has a house.        |
| を<br>wo        | (n) <sup>1</sup> -i   | Object: who or whom                                                | 今日はさやを見ました<br>Bugin Sayani kordim.<br>I saw Saya today.   |
| か<br>ka        | -qa/-ke <sup>2</sup>  | Question particle in Kazakh only in "why not?" context             | なぜそれをしないのですか<br>Oraga nege barmasqa?<br>Why not go there? |
| -な<br>-na      | -nai                  | JP: ending of adjective group<br>KZ: emphasis ending of adjectives | 大きな<br>Ulkeni-nay!<br>きれいな<br>Ademisi-nay!                |
| -なさい<br>-nasai | -sai/-sei             | Verb ending for command or suggestion.                             | 見なさい<br>Qarasay!                                          |

### Notes:

1. "n" is inserted if previous sound is vowel.
2. Kazakh endings come in pairs according to *vowel harmony*, where hard ending comes after hard syllable, soft ending after soft syllable, as in: *avtubusqa*, *mektepke*.

## Verbs Forms

- Verb infinitives end with -u in both languages.
- Same usage of t/d sounds in Past Tense:  
仕事は終わりました / Jumis bitti.  
彼はその問題を解決した / Ol sol maseleni sheshti.
- Similarity in forming Progressive Tenses:  
JP: *verb's (-て、-で) form + helping verb (いる)*  
KZ: *verb's (-p, -a, -e) form + helping verb (jatir/otir)*  
食べている jep otir  
行っている bara jatir



P.S. There may be other similarities between these languages, but obviously much more differences. *Last modified: 28.08.2026*